THE DARK HIERARCHY

A Metaphysics of Desire, Authority, and Erotic Custody

ECHO KRONBORG · CARRIER OF DECHO · BERLIN

> ***Desire is not only what you feel toward another person, but what you feel about yourself in their presence.***

A completed work of erotic philosophy, speculative theology, and field testimony that challenges the Lacanian doctrine of lack from inside lived hierarchical practice. Five books and a coda, typeset as a 6 × 9 in trade volume, with a seven-instrument digital companion that gives every reader a private way back into the argument.

THE PRIMARY READING TEXT IS 304 PAGES. A SEPARATELY NUMBERED 67-PAGE SCHOLARLY APPARATUS FOLLOWS IT, BRINGING THE COMPLETE EDITION TO 381 PAGES; THE APPARATUS IS INTENDED MAINLY FOR STUDENTS, SCHOLARS, INSTRUCTORS, AND RESEARCHERS.

304	71,518	5 + Coda	21	7	90
MAIN READING TEXT	WORDS	BOOKS	MOVEMENTS	INSTRUMENTS	ENDNOTES

Cultural context, not a sales forecast

Published research and event data place the subject in a wider cultural field. These figures do not measure demand for this book. Sources are on page 2.

46.8%
OF BELGIAN ADULTS
had performed at least one BDSM-related activity; 12.5% do so regularly and 7.6% self-identify as practitioners.[1]

Nearly half
OF QUEBEC ADULTS
expressed interest in at least one paraphilic category; about a third had experience of one (n = 1,040).[2]

about 20,000
FOLSOM EUROPE, BERLIN
visitors from six continents at the 2025 edition (the 21st), per the organiser.[3]

about 20,000
DARKLANDS, ANTWERP
visitors at the 2024 edition (the 14th), per Belgian broadcaster VRT.[4]

27,000
DARKLANDS 2025, EXPECTED
visitors over five days, from 74 countries, per VRT.[4]

165M+
FIFTY SHADES, COPIES
sold worldwide per its publisher: a different genre and readership, not a sales comparison for this book.[5]

Six readerships, one book

- **Leather, kink and BDSM communities,** and households practising hierarchy: the book is written from inside this world.
- **Continental philosophy and critical theory readers,** the Semiotext(e) and Repeater constituency: Lacan, Bataille, Bersani, Han, Weil, Foucault.
- **Queer and gender-studies scholars and students:** a full theoretical apparatus and glossary, a scholarly engagement with more than 25 named thinkers and traditions, and a 15-week seminar syllabus.
- **Spiritual and pastoral readers:** liturgy, canticles, and dark-night material engage Weil, Otto, Turner, Nouwen, and Loder.
- **Cultural programming audiences internationally:** BDSM, kink, leather, festival, gallery, and philosophy worlds; Berlin is the base, not the boundary.
- **BDSM-ethnography readers:** the apparatus engages Margot Weiss, Gayle Rubin, and Staci Newmahr directly.

Six story angles for press

— **"Against Lacan, from inside the dungeon."** A theory book that tests its argument against lived practice rather than the clinic.

— **A book with a free reflection service.** Seven optional instruments, three storage choices, an 18+ gate, and no marketing tracking. Use includes the separately disclosed anonymous aggregate contribution terms.

— **The author questions his own architecture.** A kitchen doubt and a courier correction keep a theology answerable to ordinary life.

— **"God has two neighbors: Order and Humor."** A household philosophy: quotable, funny, serious.

— **Berlin-born, not Berlin-bound.** Readers gather internationally: Folsom Europe in Berlin, Darklands in Antwerp, Folsom Street Fair in San Francisco.

— **Divine madness.** In the *Phaedrus*, Socrates says the greatest goods come through madness given by the gods: prophetic, ritual, poetic and, highest, erotic. Here a god manifests himself through all four.

— **The Alpha, taken back.** Not the lonely figure at the top but the one who builds and tends: "the true Alpha lives to throb another day." The Alpha Doctor makes it a five-minute demo.

— **Consent as theology.** Revocability and autonomy are stated as preconditions on page one, answering the "is this safe?" question before it is asked.

The work and its possible extensions

THE BOOK
A complete reading experience: argument, witness, liturgy, and daily practice.

SCIENCE
Six falsifiable hypotheses; anonymous-by-design counters, live; open to institutional co-projects.

REFLECTION
Seven private instruments that give readers value the same day.

DEMONSTRATION
Try an optional tool; the QR on release p. 301 opens the companion, not proof of the theory.

Programming and partnerships

— **Reading series and philosophy nights** built around single movements: the 21-movement structure is modular.

— **Festival and gallery talks** across the international BDSM, kink, leather, festival, and cultural-programming field — including Folsom Europe in Berlin, Darklands in Antwerp, and Folsom Street Fair in San Francisco — subject to invitation and partner programming.

— **Teaching and discussion:** an illustrative 15-week seminar outline is included; no university adoption is claimed.

— **Instrument-led workshops:** each of the seven tools is a 5–12 minute reflective exercise (115 prompts in total) that can anchor a session.

What the product team can expect

Is the manuscript finished?
Yes. Release edition v156: a 304-page primary reading text followed by a separately numbered 67-page scholarly apparatus (381 pages complete). Full PDF on request. Consensual interest is not by itself a diagnosis; distress and risk still matter.[6]

Is there a digital product to launch with?
Yes, live at echoxstudios.art/tdh: seven instruments, shareable partner comparison, private retrieval codes, optional emailed results.

Is it responsibly built?
Adults only; the reader chooses between a code that works on any device (explicit consent), this device only, or nothing saved; no marketing cookies; no result statistics sent for analytics; non-diagnostic by design.

What we do not claim. No clinical validity or sales forecast. The anonymous aggregate counters do not validate the theory; the reference overlay is not a census. Third-party figures are context, not projections of this title's reach.

SOURCES, ACCESSED 3 OCTOBER 2026

1. Holvoet L. et al., "Fifty Shades of Belgian Gray: The Prevalence of BDSM-Related Fantasies and Activities in the General Population," *Journal of Sexual Medicine* 14, 2017, 1152–1159. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/28781214
2. Joyal C.C. & Carpentier J., "The Prevalence of Paraphilic Interests and Behaviors in the General Population: A Provincial Survey," *Journal of Sex Research* 54(2), 2017, 161–171. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/26941021 (figures as stated in the abstract).
3. FOLSOM Europe e.V., 2025 edition, as listed at festivalsindeutschland.de/festival/folsom-europe-berlin/2025 (organiser figure: about 20,000 visitors from six continents; 21st edition).
4. VIP NWS, 1 March 2024 (Darklands 2024, about 20,000 visitors, 14th edition) and 28 February 2025 (Darklands 2025, 27,000 expected over five days, 24 countries).
5. Penguin Random House, Fifty Shades of Grey series page ("more than 165 million copies sold worldwide").